

You use this data to help you:

- Understand your audience and the market you operate in
- Design shoes to suit your audience (height, weight, age, state of knees, etc.)
- Design soles that suit the terrain your audience is in the habit of traversing (specific to the city they're jogging in for example)
- Generate ad revenue with targeted advertising and suggestions.
- Direct your audience's buying habits and decisions and more.

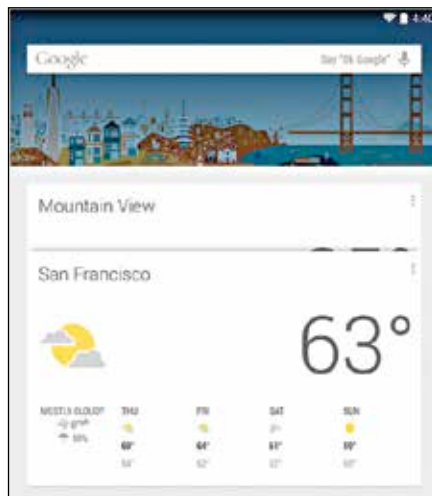
Your audience gains the following information from the data you collected:

- Suitable walking/jogging locations
- A better social life (hopefully)
- A personalised shoe shopping experience (maybe even personalised shoes)
- Big Data on themselves that they can make use of if they see fit to do so, among other things.

All of this can theoretically be generated by an idea, an app and a willing audience. All you're doing is analysing that data, localising it and helping yourself and your audience at the same time.

Case Study No. 2 (Homes)

We're taking a real world example here, www.housing.com. The idea was simple, in the founder's own words, "We wanted something better. So we built it" (it's not an original quote for sure, but we digress). Starting out as simply a better way to find accommodation, maybe for the founders themselves, the site has moved on, transformed into the

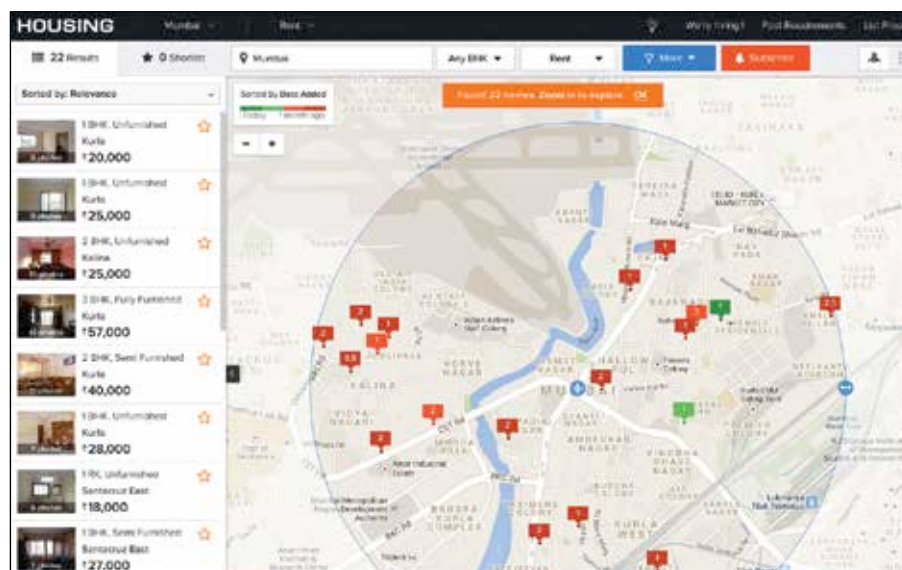


The irrepressible Google Now

most convenient destination for finding a house across select locations in India.

How does it work? You go to the site, pick a location, the radius within which you're willing to stay and voila! You have a page that's filled to the brim with listings that you didn't know existed.

The folks behind Housing.com didn't just stumble across this data somewhere. They knew what they wanted, devised a method of acquiring this data and then sought about acquiring it. They spent months talking to estate agents, going door to door, gathering images of the houses and rooms on offer, devising means of rating locales for child-friendliness and such like. This was hot, sweaty, back-breaking work that was required to lay the ground work for such an endeavour.



Specify a location and a radius and Housing.com will give you results.

The result however is a site that's grown by leaps and bounds and might end up as the ultimate housing destination. Again, the data was there for anyone to take, the technology available for anyone to implement, but it took someone with vision and drive to spot the opportunity and put in the effort to grab it. Other sites with a similar mind-set include localbanya.com and [Squeakee \(www.offerson.com\)](http://Squeakee.com).

Case Study No. 3 (Location)

Google's Street View hasn't come to India for various reasons, legal and otherwise, but that didn't stop Wonobo (www.wonobo.com) from going ahead and doing something about it. Already in the business of offering mapping services (mapping data that's at the very least, an even match for Google Maps), Wonobo set out to "use mapping technology to better people's lives".

What Wonobo did is what Street View could only promise. They set about with a plan of mapping our country with their own variant of Street View, but they didn't stop there. They mapped over 50 cities in the country, yes, but in the course of mapping the city, they also pinned every single grocers, restaurant, business, hotel, *chai wala*, and *raddi wala* they could find. Not just that, they gave them a web-page to call their own, added pictures, contact details and have allowed for such things as a full menu, items for sale, etc. Rooms in hotels, dining areas in restaurants, all can be captured in a photo sphere of sorts and showcased for all to see.

The staggering scale of the data that was (is) being generated (and the people being empowered) is only matched by the speed and efficiency with which the entire project was carried out. The resultant site is a surprisingly comprehensive map of a city in what can be considered to be 3D. All you've got to do is fire up the site (it works even on mobile devices) and "walk" the streets, browsing through local offerings and discover hidden areas that you'd normally never venture into.

Magic

All these case studies only serve to highlight the shocking amount of information that can be extracted from those tiny, insignificant bits of data that are gathered about you and your surroundings. The